Competitor watch · Q1 2025

Aalberts and listed peers · figures in each company's reporting currency, millions unless stated · data as of 2026-11-04

Peer comparison

Company	Report	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin	Change	Margin measure
Aalberts	**Q1 2025 trading update**	**778.3 EUR**	**−3.9%**	**−3.3%**	**13.6%**	**−60 bps**	**EBITA margin**
IMI	Q1 2025 trading update	–	−5.0%	−3.0%	–		Adj. operating margin
Belimo	no report for this period						
Xylem	Q1 2025 results	2,069 USD	+1.8%	+3.0%	20.4%	+120 bps	Adj. EBITDA margin
Ecolab	Q1 2025 results	3,695 USD	−1.5%	+3.0%	16.0%	+190 bps	Organic operating margin
Watts	Q1 2025 results	558.0 USD	−2.3%	−2.1%	19.0%		Adj. operating margin
Emerson*	Q1 2025 results (quarter ended 31 Dec 2024)	4,175 USD	+1.4%	+2.0%	28.0%	+340 bps	Adj. segment EBITA margin
Pentair	Q1 2025 results	1,010 USD	−0.7%	−0.8%	24.0%		Adj. return on sales
Georg Fischer	no report for this period						

Reported margin comparison

Aalberts		**13.6%** −60 bps EBITA margin
IMI	no margin disclosed	
Belimo	no report	
Xylem		**20.4%** +120 bps Adj. EBITDA margin
Ecolab		**16.0%** +190 bps Organic operating margin
Watts		**19.0%** Adj. operating margin
Emerson*		**28.0%** +340 bps Adj. segment EBITA margin
Pentair		**24.0%** Adj. return on sales
Georg Fischer	no report	

Each company's own margin measure; levels are not like-for-like.

Company detail

Aalberts · Q1 2025 trading update

Revenue **778.3** EUR m (−3.9% reported) · Organic growth **−3.3%** · EBITA margin **13.6%** −60 bps

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Building	408.5	−1.0%	+1.7%	13.2% (12.1%)	
Industry	262.6	−4.9%	−6.9%	16.3% (18.2%)	Automotive and machine building weak; aerospace, maritime, power and defence growing
Semicon	111.6	−11.3%	−11.3%	10.0% (14.4%)	Customer inventory adjustments

Segment growth: Building returned to growth (+1.7% organic) with margin +110 bps to 13.2%. Industry −6.9% (weak automotive, machine building, Germany and France) and semicon −11.3% (customer destocking) pulled margins down to 16.3% and 10.0%.

Source: Q1 2025 press release (PDF)

IMI · Q1 2025 trading update

Revenue not reported in this update · Organic growth **−3.0%** · Process Automation orders **+7%** (organic; aftermarket +19% incl. large nuclear orders; order book +13%)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Automation	–	–	−4.0%		Temporary disruption from the cyber incident
Process Automation	–	–	−1.0%		Against +27% a year earlier; project phasing
Industrial Automation	–	–	−7.0%		Cyber incident and subdued industrial demand in Europe and the Americas
Life Technology	–	–	−2.0%		
Climate Control	–	–	+4.0%		Good demand for energy-efficient products
Life Science & Fluid Control	–	–	0.0%		
Transport	–	–	−16.0%		Against +19% a year earlier

Segment growth: Organic revenue −3% as expected (reported −5% with currency and the IMF disposal), but group margins improved. Process Automation orders +7% and aftermarket orders +19%; Climate Control +4%. Industrial Automation −7% from the cyber incident; Transport −16% against a strong comparator.

Outlook: FY 2025 guidance reconfirmed: mid-single-digit organic growth; ~2% currency headwind partly offset by fewer shares (~249m).

Source: Q1 2025 trading update (PDF)

Xylem · Q1 2025 results

Revenue **2,069** USD m (+1.8% reported) · Organic growth **+3.0%** · Adj. EBITDA margin **20.4%** +120 bps · Adj. EPS **$1.03** (+14% vs $0.90) · Free cash flow **−38** (15 a year earlier) · Orders **2,158** (-2% organic; -4% reported)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Water Infrastructure	581.0	–	+5.0%	20.7%	Orders 626 (+1% organic)
Applied Water	435.0	–	+1.0%	19.5%	Orders 486 (+3% organic)
Measurement & Control Solutions	490.0	–	+6.0%	21.0%	Orders 402 (-8% organic)
Water Solutions & Services	563.0	–	+1.0%	21.7%	Orders 644 (-5% organic)

Segment growth: Growth led by MCS (+6%) and Water Infrastructure (+5%); Applied Water and WSS +1%. Margins up sharply in WI and AW (+290/+300 bps) on productivity and price; MCS margin −170 bps. Record Q1 adj. EBITDA margin and EPS.

Outlook: FY 2025 adj. EPS raised to $4.50–4.70.

Source: Q1 2025 earnings package (PDF) · Q1 2025 earnings release

Ecolab · Q1 2025 results

Revenue **3,695** USD m (−1.5% reported) · Organic growth **+3.0%** · Organic operating margin **16.0%** +190 bps · Adj. EPS **$1.50** (+12%; GAAP $1.41)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Global Water	1,800	+2.6%	+2.0%	14.4% (13.9%)	
Food & Beverage	–	–	+2.0%		
Paper	–	–	0.0%		
Global Institutional & Specialty	1,406	−2.8%	+4.0%	21.2% (17.8%)	
Institutional	–	–	+4.0%		-5% at fixed currency incl. acquisitions
Specialty	–	–	+3.0%		
Global Pest Elimination	278.1	+6.8%	+5.0%	16.6% (17.9%)	
Global Life Sciences	167.0	+4.8%	+5.0%	15.1% (12.1%)	

Segment growth: Organic +3%: Pest +5% and Life Sciences +5% led; Water +2%, Institutional & Specialty +4% organic (−3% at fixed rates after the surgical-solutions sale). Life Sciences OI +31%, Institutional & Specialty OI +16%; Pest OI flat.

Outlook: FY 2025 adj. EPS growth of 12–15%; 20% organic OI margin by 2027.

Source: Q1 2025 earnings presentation (PDF)

Watts · Q1 2025 results

Revenue **558.0** USD m (−2.3% reported) · Organic growth **−2.1%** · Adj. operating margin **19.0%** · Adj. EPS **$2.37** · Free cash flow **46**

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Americas	418.1	−0.2%	−1.1%	23.4% (22.1%)	Fewer shipping days (~3 pts); acquisitions +USD 5.0m; segment earnings +5.6% organic
Europe	108.4	−12.1%	−9.2%	13.9% (15.7%)	Volume decline; weak heat-pump and boiler markets; segment earnings -20.1% organic
APMEA	31.5	+9.4%	+13.2%	17.5% (18.1%)	Price and volume; segment earnings +9.6% organic

Segment growth: Organic −2.1%, mostly from ~3 pts fewer shipping days: Americas −1.1%, Europe −9.2%; APMEA +13.2%. Americas segment earnings still +5.6% organic on price; Europe earnings −20%.

Source: Q1 2025 Form 10-Q (PDF)

Emerson* · Q1 2025 results (quarter ended 31 Dec 2024)

Revenue **4,175** USD m (+1.4% reported) · Underlying growth **+2.0%** · Adj. segment EBITA margin **28.0%** +340 bps · Adj. EPS **$1.38** (+13% vs $1.22) · Free cash flow **694**

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Intelligent Devices	2,843	+0.7%	+2.0%	26.1% (23.8%)	
Final Control	976.0	+3.8%	+5.0%		
Measurement & Analytical	975.0	+3.0%	+4.0%		
Discrete Automation	580.0	−5.4%	−4.0%		
Safety & Productivity	312.0	−3.1%	−3.0%		
Software and Control	1,352	+2.9%	+4.0%	31.6% (26.1%)	
Control Systems & Software	690.0	+2.2%	+3.0%		
Test & Measurement	359.0	−6.0%	−5.0%		
AspenTech	303.0	+17.9%	+18.0%		
REGIONS					
Americas	–	–	+3.0%		
Asia, Middle East & Africa	–	–	+4.0%		China −5%
Europe	–	–	−2.0%		

Segment growth: Underlying +2%: Final Control +5% and Measurement & Analytical +4% offset Discrete Automation (−4%) and Safety & Productivity (−3%); AspenTech +18%. Adj. segment EBITA margin 28.0% (+340 bps), Software and Control 31.6% (+550 bps). Old segment structure.

Source: Q1 2025 Form 10-Q (PDF)

Pentair · Q1 2025 results

Revenue **1,010** USD m (−0.7% reported) · Core sales growth **−0.8%** · Adj. return on sales **24.0%** · Adj. EPS **$1.11** ($0.94 in Q1 2024) · Free cash flow **−56**

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Flow	367.9	−4.3%	−2.9%	22.7% (20.1%)	
Water Solutions	258.2	−5.5%	−4.3%	23.5% (20.4%)	
Pool	383.9	+6.8%	+4.2%	32.8% (30.8%)	

Segment growth: Pool core +4.2% with segment income +14%; Flow −2.9% and Water Solutions −4.3% core, but both raised segment income (+8% and +9%) and return on sales on price and productivity.

Source: Q1 2025 Form 10-Q (PDF)

Other key competitors (relevance to HFC 1–5)

Caleffi · relevance 5/5 (very high)

Private (Caleffi family) · revenue ~EUR 273m (2025, Caleffi S.p.A. accounts) · FTEs ~1,600; 13 plants in Italy (company)

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** ISH 2025 (Frankfurt, Mar): launched PLURIMOD, DISCAL (separators), CALEFFI eCAL and LEGIOMIX evo; stand themed on water management, heat-pump components, sustainable HVAC comfort and water/health protection. [Caleffi ISH 2025 news]

Danfoss · relevance 5/5 (very high)

Private (Danfoss family / Bitten & Mads Clausen Foundation) · revenue EUR 9.43bn (2025) · FTEs ~39,300 (H1 2026 report)

- **Performance:** Danfoss reports half-yearly only: Q1 2025 organic growth was negative, before a slightly positive Q2 (per the H1 2025 announcement). [Danfoss H1 2025 announcement]

Reflex Winkelmann (reflexGroup) · relevance 5/5 (very high)

Private (Winkelmann Group, family-owned) · revenue n/d (not published) · FTEs >2,100 (company)

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** ISH 2025 (Frankfurt, Mar): launched the Reflex Greenbox, a prefabricated unit for filling and treating heating water, alongside Fillset / Fillcontrol Smart with app-based fault diagnosis and the Hydroflow fresh-water station. [Reflex ISH 2025 press release (PDF)]

Bell & Gossett (Xylem) · relevance 4/5 (high)

Xylem (NYSE: XYL), Applied Water segment · revenue Applied Water segment USD 1,849m (2025) · FTEs n/d (part of Xylem)

- **Performance:** Xylem Applied Water Q1 2025 (incl. Bell & Gossett): revenue USD 435m (+1% organic), adj. EBITDA margin 19.5% (+300 bps); orders USD 486m (+3%). [Xylem Q1 2025 earnings package (PDF)]

Oventrop · relevance 4/5 (high)

Private (family-owned) · revenue ~EUR 273m (Wikipedia; year n/d) · FTEs ~1,000 in Olsberg/Brilon; group ~1,355

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** ISH 2025: Regudis W-HTE GT flat station for replacing old gas boilers in line with the German Buildings Energy Act (GEG); first cloud solution OV+ to connect Regudis H substations. [HaustechnikDialog]

Spirotech · relevance 4/5 (high)

Private (family-owned) · revenue n/d (not published) · FTEs n/d

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** ISH 2025 (Frankfurt, Mar): showed new dirt-separation and vacuum-degassing products next to the SpiroVent and SpiroPress ranges. [ISH exhibitor profile]

ESBE · relevance 3/5 (moderate)

Private · revenue n/d · FTEs n/d

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** Set up a UK subsidiary. [ESBE news]

Fernox · relevance 3/5 (moderate)

Element Solutions (NYSE: ESI) · revenue n/d · FTEs n/d

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** Exhibited at ISH 2025, Frankfurt (Mar 2025). [Fernox news]

Frese · relevance 3/5 (moderate)

Vexve (Finland) since Feb 2025 · revenue n/d (Vexve group ~EUR 200m combined) · FTEs ~250 (at acquisition)

- **M&A:** Vexve completed the acquisition of Frese from the founding family (3 Feb 2025), creating a ~EUR 200m hydronic-network valve group. [Vexve · Valve World]

Wilo · relevance 3/5 (moderate)

Private (Wilo-Foundation) · revenue EUR 1,918.7m (2025) · FTEs ~9,000 (2025)

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** Expanded its Dubai plant to double production capacity (Mar 2025). [ME Construction News]

Resideo (Honeywell Home) · relevance 2/5 (low)

Listed (NYSE: REZI) · revenue USD 7.5bn (2025, incl. ADI) · FTEs ~14,600 (data aggregator)

- **Performance:** Products & Solutions (Honeywell Home) Q1 2025 revenue USD 649m (+5%). [Resideo Q1 2025 release]

No dated public information found for this period: Grundfos (4), Taco Comfort Solutions (4), ADEY (3), Armstrong Fluid Technology (3), Cetetherm (3), Giacomini (3), HERZ Armaturen (3), PAW (3), PEWO Energietechnik (3), Siemens Smart Infrastructure (3), Wessels Company (3), Zilmet (3), Alfa Laval (2), Victaulic (2).

* Emerson's financial year ends on 30 September, so its quarters are offset from the calendar: Q1 = October–December, Q2 = January–March, Q3 = April–June, Q4 = July–September. Quarters are shown as Emerson labels them (e.g. Q1 2026 = October–December 2025). * Siemens Smart Infrastructure: Siemens' fiscal year ends 30 September; quarters are shown as Siemens labels them (Q1 = October–December). For half-year reporters Q2 = H1; FY 2025 = full-year results. Organic growth as each company defines it (Belimo: local currencies; Emerson: underlying; Pentair: core).